

GREED

For those who just want more than should be humanly allowed, we have enough to satisfy your hunger...

THIS MONTH: ASAP Connect, UMi Super, ModMic 4.0, KENT Aura, Rolls Royce 103EX and a lot more...

TEMPTATION

If you're wondering what to do with yourself or how to spend some time getting cultured, this section is for you...

THIS MONTH: Movie Review: X-Men Apocalypse, App Watch: Timeout, Mypoolin, Yumchek



ASUS Zenbo

At Computex this year, ASUS stole the show when they unveiled Zenbo, a robot assistant with no mention about its specifications. It can be controlled by voice and has camera sensors to detect its surroundings. We can only speculate that Zenbo is running on Android for software on top of Intel hardware. This is for now the closest we've got to building R2D2 commercially.

DESIRE > SHOWCASE

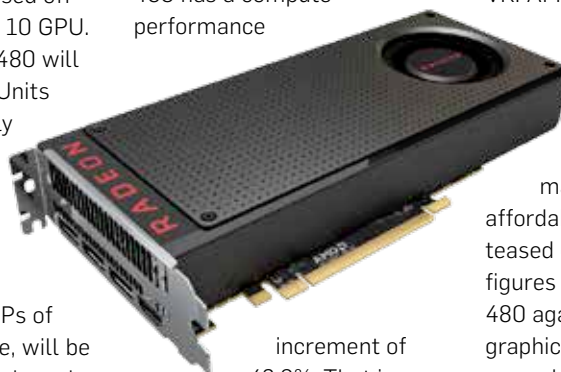
AMD Radeon RX480

A power packed mid range performer

Polaris marks AMD's fourth iteration of GCN (Graphics Core Next) and could very well be based off the rumoured Polaris 10 GPU. The AMD Radeon RX480 will feature 36 Compute Units (CUs), so cumulatively that makes it 2304 streaming processors. AMD has said that the RX 480 is capable of more than 5 TeraFLOPs of compute performance, will be available in two SKUs based on memory capacity (4/8 GB) which in turn has a bus width of 256-bit.

A price tag of \$199, makes the RX480 a direct successor to the AMD R9 380. So going by the TFLOPS

that both cards are capable of i.e. 3.5 TFLOPs and 5 TFLOPs, we see that the RX 480 has a compute performance



increment of 42.9%. That is a tremendous generational increment.

The not so surprising change is the reduction in TDP for the card to 150W, which can be attributed to the 14nm FinFET manufacturing

process. The main aim of these power-efficient GPUs happens to be democratising VR. AMD mentioned explicitly

how getting a VR-ready PC costs and the RX 480 is meant to change that scenario and make VR all the more affordable. In fact, AMD has teased certain benchmark figures which pit the RX 480 against higher-end graphics cards which cost around \$500. AMD notes that bringing down the PC cost considerably (we're looking at a reduction of more than \$300 here) is paramount towards attaining this objective of making VR more widespread. We sure hope so!

Liva Core Z



Based on the new Intel Pentium and Celeron processors, the

Core Z is the next in the line-up from ECS's Core series, directed towards normal PC use-cases.

BRIX Gaming UHD



Gigabyte's BRIX lineup saw new

devices on display, one of them called the Gaming UHD, sporting a neat aluminium design and packing both i5 and i7 variants in barebones.

AsRock DeskMini



Following up to the new mini-STX standard of motherboards,

the Desktop Mini is a powerful mini-PC capable of housing the latest Skylake processor and DDR4 memory modules.

Liva Core Pro



ECS has also showcased their iteration of a mini-STX based mini-PC

and they are calling it the Core Pro. Directed towards the DIY community, they are open to creative enclosures.